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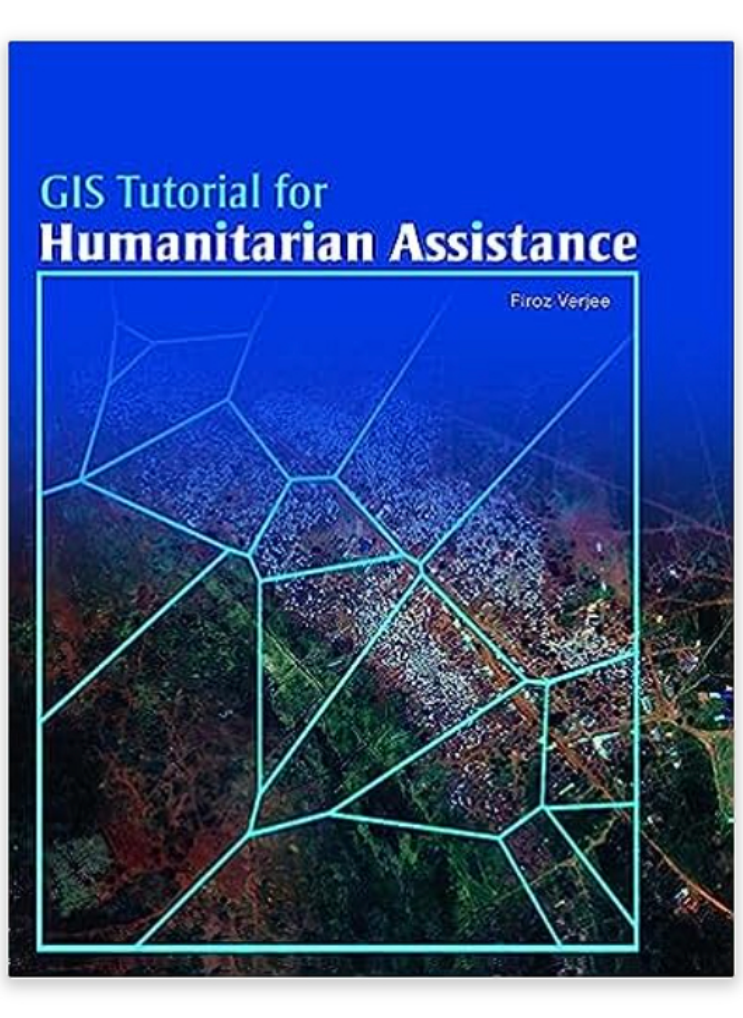

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1st Edition

by Firoz Verjee (Author)

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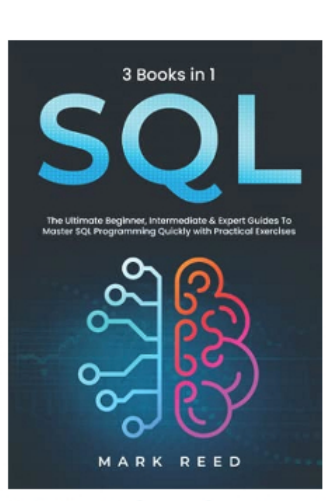

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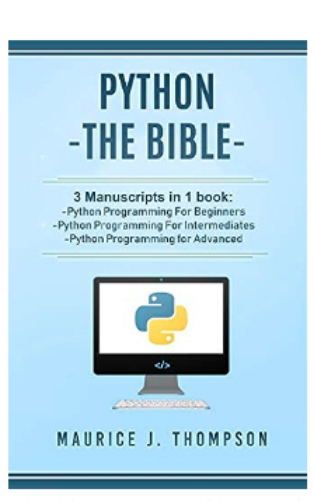

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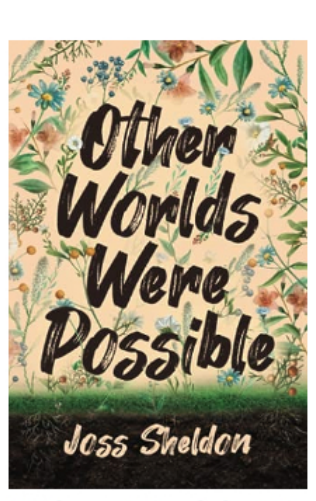

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About the Author

Firoz Verjee is senior research associate at the Institute for Crisis, Disaster & Risk Management at the George Washington University. For more than 16 years he has specialized in the application of remote sensing and GIS, primarily within the fields of disaster risk reduction and humanitarian assistance. Verjee has provided expert services to the U.S. National Oceanic & Atmospheric Administration, the World Bank Group, the United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs, and FOCUS Humanitarian Assistance.

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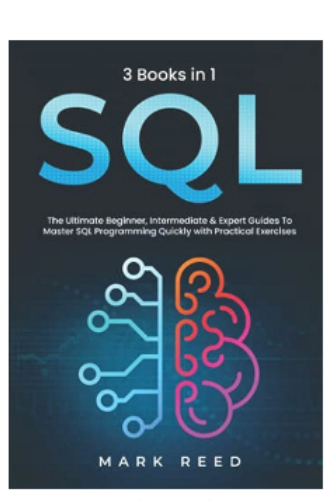

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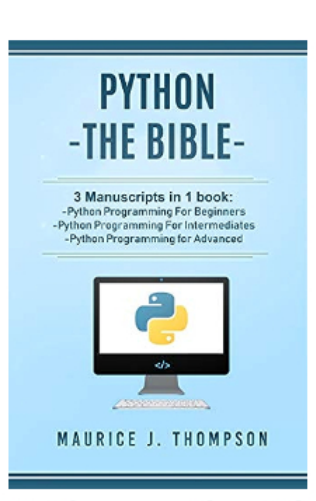

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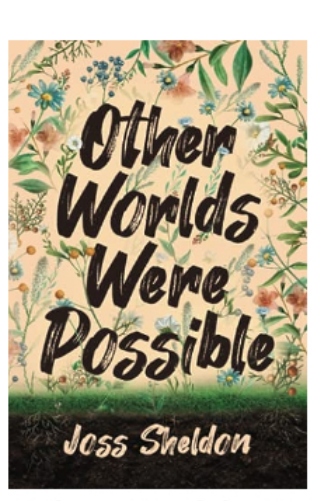

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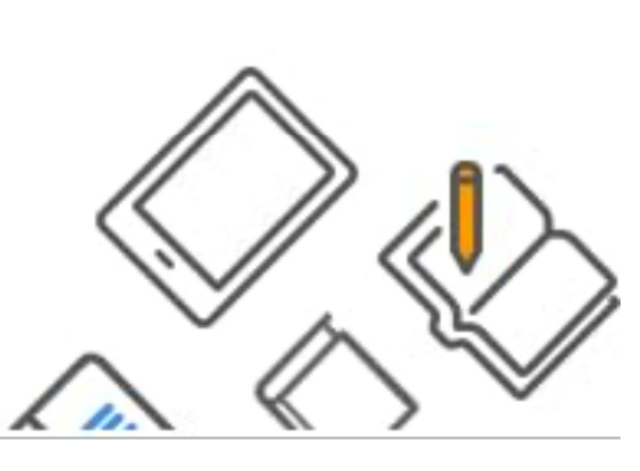

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Reviewed in the United States on July 24, 2012

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C K Smith

★★★★★ **Real world GIS for humanitarians and others**

Reviewed in the United States on December 20, 2010

Dr. Verjee's offering is a solid tutorial with interesting, real world case studies and thoughtful, relevant exercises. While it will be essential reading for those who are seeking knowledge in humanitarian GIS, it may also be an intriguing addition to GIS curriculum that seeks to reinforce a multi-discipline approach and demonstrate it in a motivating and meaningful application. The case studies cover a breadth of issues that would not be found in other specialized tutorials and brings a realism lacking in many technical how-to manuals. I encourage GIS educators to consider this as a secondary text should they want to insert more reality into their programs and demonstrate to their students the use of GIS in critical, life saving work.

Secondarily, as someone who has worked in this field for nearly two decades, this book is a wonderful compilation of case studies that begins to bring the work of many GIS professionals into the public view. Humanitarian GIS experts in the US and around the world, though not as visible as their hands-on counterparts in disaster response, often work just as hard and have significant impact on targeting of aid, effectiveness of operations and general situational awareness. This text communicates the fact that GIS is a humanitarian activity and helps to provide a foundation for professionalisms within this community.

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K. Chamberlain

★★★★★ **Comprehensive exercises for real world GIS application**

Reviewed in the United States on December 28, 2010

I highly recommend this book for anyone looking to explore applications of GIS analysis in humanitarian assistance, and more broadly in emergency management. I worked through Dr. Verjee's tutorial as part of a graduate level `GIS in emergency response' course. The author provides realistic exercises that allow the user to go beyond the steps of just completing the technical analysis, also requiring him or her to consider legitimate questions about data collection, data accuracy, development of practical solutions and policy, etc. This book does an excellent job of capturing those challenges and forcing the reader to incorporate those and similar issues in drawing final conclusions.

The exercises provided cover a broad range of problems/challenges requiring an equally wide application of geoprocessing tools, and aren't just a repeat of the same few types of analysis. This kept the tutorials both interesting and effective at expanding my GIS skill set. A number of the exercises build on skills and products developed in earlier examples. The step-by-step method of instruction and comprehensiveness of the exercises, from data research and collection through final map development, makes the skills learned easily transferrable to real world GIS challenges in the field of humanitarian assistance (or any field).

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